

Robbie Slape

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I work on emerging organisational and strategic problems where the path forward is not yet settled. My experience spans AI enablement, strategic policy, futures, regulation and program delivery, with particular strengths in framing complex problems, convening different perspectives and translating insight into practical action.

Beginning in urban planning, my government career started in strategic policy, and have since worked across regulation, emerging technology and organisational change roles. I have increasingly been drawn towards futures, systems change and technology integration challenges. My approach combines:

- **Problem framing and synthesis:** clarify the real problem, connect perspectives and turn ambiguity into useful choices.
- **Strategic facilitation and convening:** design conversations that surface assumptions, build shared understanding and move groups towards action.
- **Systems and futures thinking:** work across longer horizons and complex institutional settings while staying grounded in practical next steps.
- **Network and relationship building:** build and steward relationships across organisations, communities and disciplines.
- **Practice-led experimentation:** use workshops, prototyping and small interventions to test ideas while making progress

Current role

AI Enablement – Assistant Director (Department of Finance) *February 2026–current*

I lead APS-wide AI enablement work supporting Australian Government agencies to navigate practical, organisational and governance barriers to AI adoption. I design interventions that help agencies clarify difficult implementation problems, bring together the expertise needed to work through them, and use recurring issues across cases to shape reusable guidance and support for the wider APS.

Alongside this, I help steward AI CoLab, an open cross-sector practitioner network that complements the formal Finance role. I design workshops and programming, build relationships across government and broader communities, and use the network to surface emerging practice, partnerships and insights that can inform APS-wide enablement work.

- Designed three connected enablement approaches that use practical agency cases to identify recurring systemic friction and inform wider guidance and intervention:
- AI Clearway brings agencies and specialist functions together to work through complex cross-boundary adoption barriers.
- AI Clinic helps agencies surface emerging challenges, clarify the underlying problem and connect with appropriate expertise or support.
- AI Enablement in a Box turns recurring lessons into reusable resources that agencies can adapt to their own operating environments.

Previous roles

Department of Infrastructure, Transport, Regional Development, Communications, Sport and the Arts – Assistant Director roles

Artificial Intelligence Strategy Lead *March 2025–February 2026*

Led the department's approach to practical AI adoption across strategy, governance, capability and organisational readiness.

- Led development of the departmental AI strategy, policy, transparency statement and staff policies, guidance and learning module design.
- Supported the enterprise-wide Microsoft Copilot rollout, aligning governance, assurance, engagement and workforce readiness.
- Built an AI community of practice and early adopter network to support experimentation, peer learning and capability development.
- Coordinated technical, policy, governance and business perspectives to identify implementation issues and shape responses.

2035 Telecommunications Strategy *June 2024–March 2025*

Led strategic foresight work to inform long-term telecommunications policy in a changing technical, regulatory and market environment.

- Designed and facilitated senior and cross-government workshops exploring scenarios, trade-offs and system impacts.
- Developed scenario models and analysis to test assumptions and broaden the futures under consideration.
- Synthesised technical, regulatory and market signals into strategic narratives and an options paper for senior decision-makers.

Program Lead — Urban Precincts and Partnerships Program *December 2023–July 2024*

Helped establish the operating model for a new national program and distributed team, including practical systems for coordination, work visibility and program management.

Cyber and Data Policy Lead - Office of Future Transport Technology *October 2021–September 2022*

Led policy work on emerging cyber security, data and privacy issues associated with connected and automated vehicles. Worked across governments, regulators and industry and represented Australia in international vehicle regulation forums.

Earlier career

Earlier roles across the APS and Queensland Government were followed by a period with the ACT Government from 2022 to 2023, before I returned to the APS. My roles have spanned aviation regulation, aviation security, strategic policy, planning and transport. Further detail is [available on my LinkedIn](#).

This breadth of experience across different levels of government, policy domains and agency cultures has shaped how I think about bureaucracy itself. Across very different roles, the same questions kept resurfacing around how institutions coordinate, adapt, innovate and organise work, and those recurring patterns now inform my broader interest in the future of work and organisational transformation.

Communities and interests

Alongside my formal roles, I build and contribute to practitioner communities, public programs and small experimental projects that let me test ideas in practice. These activities extend my work across convening, network-building, communication and hands-on experimentation.

Creative Bureaucracy Festival Australia and New Zealand Co-founder, 2023-

Co-founded and delivered the 2025 program with partners across 13 cities, building the program through distributed partnerships rather than dedicated funding or central resourcing.

Innovation Community Lead, APS Professions Co-lead, including Innovation Month 2026

Build cross-disciplinary learning and collaboration across the APS, including co-leading the 2026 Innovation Month program and creating opportunities for practitioners to share, test and discuss emerging approaches.

Algorithmic Futures Producer, 2023-2025

Produced editorial content on future governance and emerging technologies, including guest research, scripting, interview preparation and post-production.

Selected projects

These projects show how I explore organisational questions through small practical experiments, using them to make problems more visible, test assumptions and create something others can engage with.

Why Is Work So Hard? Build a Bureaucrat Bot entry – Innovation Month, July 2026

With my contest partner, designed and built an exploratory tool to help people examine how work actually happens, identify what may be creating friction and find small practical interventions to test.

Adopt This! Interactive simulation of institutional coordination, August 2026

Built an interactive simulation that puts policy-makers inside the complexity of AI adoption, exposing tacit knowledge, competing responsibilities and institutional constraints that abstract rules can miss.

Education

Master of Technology Governance, Australian National University (2026)

Certificate in Public Participation (IAP2), International Association for Public Participation (2025)

Graduate Certificate of Project Management, Queensland University of Technology (2017)

Bachelor of Urban and Regional Planning (Hons.), University of South Australia (2015)